

Table 6.1.11 : Distribution of Population by Ethnic Group and District, 2012 and 2024

District	Total		Sinhalese		Sri Lanka Tamil		Indian Tamil/ Malaiyaga Thamilar		Sri Lanka Moor/Muslim		Burgher		Malay		Other	
	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024	2012	2024
Sri Lanka	20,359,439	21,781,800	15,250,081	16,144,037	2,269,266	2,681,627	839,504	600,360	1,892,638	2,283,246	38,293	31,721	44,130	26,650	25,527	14,159
Colombo	2,324,349	2,375,415	1,778,971	1,807,945	235,090	243,856	24,289	15,427	249,609	285,346	13,306	10,643	14,444	8,249	8,640	3,949
Gampaha	2,304,833	2,436,142	2,086,469	2,188,512	81,245	97,925	9,137	6,575	97,621	123,220	10,784	7,030	12,720	9,488	6,857	3,392
Kalutara	1,221,948	1,305,784	1,060,107	1,119,109	23,035	41,361	23,217	7,198	113,320	136,412	1,188	840	689	476	392	388
Kandy	1,375,382	1,461,895	1,023,488	1,077,312	69,210	122,772	85,111	38,311	191,570	219,905	2,384	1,891	2,444	1,001	1,175	703
Matale	484,531	526,870	391,305	424,788	24,279	42,172	23,238	7,716	44,786	51,471	386	359	392	283	145	81
Nuwara Eliya	711,644	725,280	282,053	281,904	32,563	60,288	377,637	362,299	17,652	19,245	761	1,252	543	216	435	76
Galle	1,063,334	1,097,372	1,003,722	1,030,354	13,953	17,600	6,146	2,883	38,790	45,672	256	244	106	85	361	534
Matara	814,048	837,889	767,580	788,804	8,772	11,119	12,127	8,082	25,254	29,430	131	259	58	44	126	151
Hambantota	599,903	671,418	582,301	651,274	2,105	2,054	120	121	6,629	13,809	146	99	8,164	3,931	438	130
Jaffna	583,882	594,751	2,284	3,395	577,338	586,491	1,807	782	2,162	3,947	126	64	23	7	142	65
Mannar	99,570	123,756	2,305	678	80,103	89,992	692	319	16,436	32,752	12	3	11	5	11	7
Vavuniya	172,115	172,312	17,138	18,575	141,144	135,164	1,979	1,625	11,748	16,632	58	32	8	4	40	280
Mullaitivu	92,238	122,619	8,927	11,190	79,107	108,082	2,281	223	1,821	3,102	49	12	11	3	42	7
Kilinochchi	113,510	136,710	1,331	1,704	110,494	133,023	1,030	685	629	1,273	1	21	2	0	23	4
Batticaloa	526,567	595,918	6,797	6,855	380,930	424,710	2,078	992	133,854	160,284	2,814	2,899	28	17	66	161
Ampara	649,402	744,551	252,458	276,583	112,457	125,751	846	664	281,702	339,290	1,036	1,168	187	136	716	959
Trincomalee	379,541	442,745	101,483	108,676	116,646	128,088	1,227	765	158,771	203,987	966	861	356	311	92	57
Kurunegala	1,618,465	1,768,156	1,479,863	1,601,899	18,041	21,775	2,594	1,788	115,302	140,888	663	478	1,220	796	782	532
Puttalam	762,396	818,816	560,838	591,753	48,341	48,544	1,953	1,229	147,546	174,497	1,152	1,726	631	558	1,935	509
Anuradhapura	860,575	960,080	782,808	870,049	4,728	5,063	477	412	70,692	83,283	246	174	161	101	1,463	998
Polonnaruwa	406,088	447,530	368,197	402,785	7,301	7,394	161	94	30,177	36,864	88	55	46	25	118	313
Badulla	815,405	872,307	595,372	640,625	21,880	81,854	150,484	95,686	44,716	52,188	992	890	1,351	715	610	349
Moneragala	451,058	527,585	428,104	499,366	8,206	14,765	5,001	1,249	9,508	12,085	116	61	63	17	60	42
Ratnapura	1,088,007	1,145,423	947,811	1,003,515	54,437	91,300	62,124	23,991	22,346	25,870	405	481	288	65	596	201
Kegalle	840,648	870,476	718,369	736,387	17,861	40,484	43,748	21,244	59,997	71,794	227	179	184	117	262	271